2010 Toyota Prius (replacement engine)

$4,350 · 290,000 miles · Private seller · Granada Hills, CA

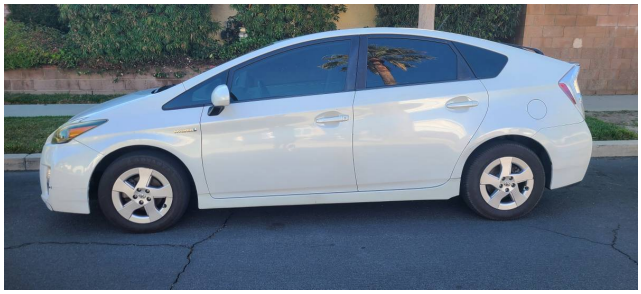
Seller: Private seller

Source: Craigslist

Listing: https://www.craigslist.org/view/d/granada-hills-2010-toyota-prius-hybrid/gvTDbRBk4spjfPDxeEUMCA

Report generated October 31, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder






+ 2 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$4,936	**$380**	**Below average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	2/5 · 10 recalls · 2,823 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$4,350.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$402.38
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$28.27
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$32.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$4,935.65
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$4,935.65
Amount financed	$0.00
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,085.65

Paid in full with your down payment — no loan needed.

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$0.00
Insurance (estimate, liability)	$70.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 50 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$95.00
Maintenance & repair reserve	$200.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$14.86
Total per month	$379.86

Running costs without the loan: **$380/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$9,644** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **liability coverage** estimate ($70/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

- Vehicle class: typical car. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.
- Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).
- A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.
- California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.
- Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Below average (2/5)

Budget Prius. The replacement engine and battery help a lot if the receipts check out, but 290k on everything else.

NHTSA data for this model year: 10 recalls · 2,823 owner complaints (183 involving a crash). Most complaints: Service Brakes (1974), Hydraulic (849), Electric (502), Vehicle Speed Control (287), Electrical System (192), Exterior Lighting (149).

Known issues for this model

- 290k on the transmission, suspension and brake actuator
- Engine and battery replacement claims need receipts
- EGR valve/cooler clogging can lead to head-gasket failure around 150–200k (ask if the EGR has been cleaned)

Check on this car before buying

- Get engine and hybrid battery receipts
- Get the VIN and run history
- Hybrid battery health scan (Dr. Prius app + OBD reader, or Toyota of Ridgecrest)
- Check coolant level and for white smoke / overheating (head gasket)
- Pre-purchase inspection before paying

Notes

Added 2026-10-30 (expanded Prius search). Posted 10/19. 290k on the body, but the seller says it has a newer engine with about 140k, and the hybrid battery and 12V battery were replaced 2 years ago. New wheel bearings. Clean title, current registration. Ask for receipts for the engine and battery. About 100–105 miles from Ridgecrest via CA-14 (about 2 hours).

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.